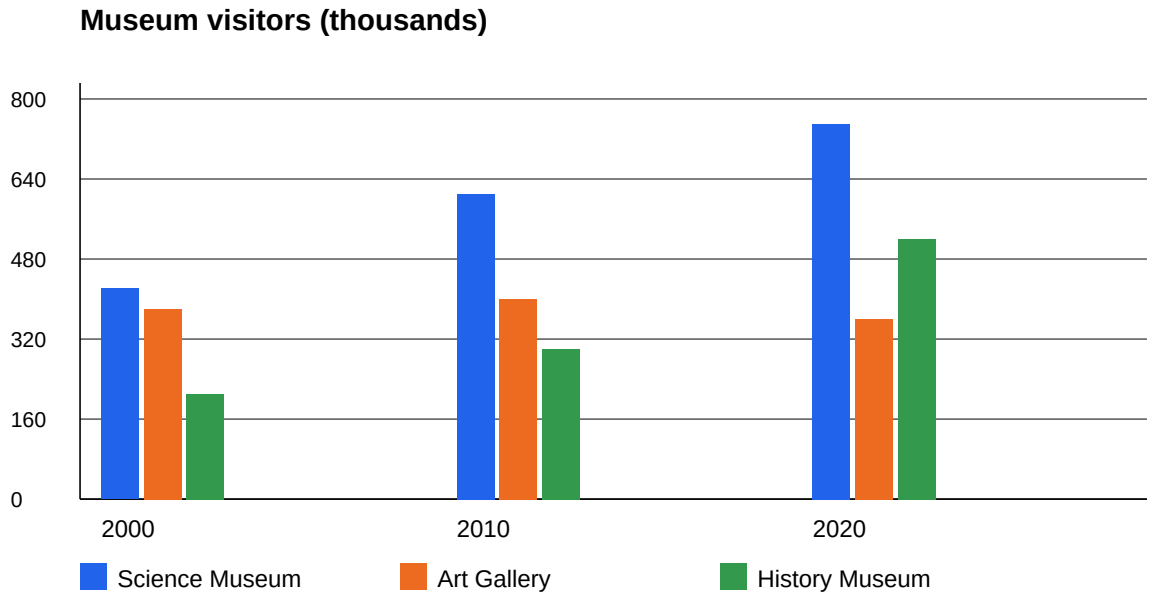
WRITING TASK 1

You should spend about 20 minutes on this task.

The chart below shows the number of visitors (in thousands) to three museums in one city in 2000, 2010 and 2020.

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant.

Write at least 150 words.



WRITING TASK 2

You should spend about 40 minutes on this task.

Write about the following topic:

Some people believe that university education should be free for every student. Others think that students should pay for their own studies. Discuss both these views and give your own opinion.

Give reasons for your answer and include any relevant examples from your own knowledge or experience.

Write at least 250 words.

Task 1 model answer

The bar chart shows how many people visited a science museum, an art gallery and a history museum in one city in 2000, 2010 and 2020.

Overall, the science museum was the most popular throughout the period, and the history museum grew fastest, while visits to the art gallery changed little.

In 2000 the science museum received 420,000 visitors, slightly more than the art gallery with 380,000. The history museum was far less popular, with just 210,000. By 2020 the science museum had grown steadily to 750,000 visitors, and the history museum had more than doubled to 520,000. The art gallery, by contrast, rose a little to 400,000 in 2010 before falling to 360,000 in 2020.

Task 2 model answer

Whether students or the state should pay for university is a question on which people feel strongly. Both views have merit, but I believe that university should be free, or very nearly so.

Those who want students to pay argue that graduates usually earn more than other workers, so it is fair that they cover the cost of the education that brings them this advantage. They also point out that free education must be paid for by taxes, including the taxes of people who never went to university.

On the other hand, free university gives every talented young person the same chance, whatever their family's income. When fees are high, many able students from poorer homes decide not to apply, and the country loses their skills. A well-educated population also benefits everyone, through better doctors, engineers and teachers.

In conclusion, although the argument that graduates should pay has some force, I am convinced that the wider benefits of free university education outweigh its cost.